

Ethics Injection Part 1: Risk Scoring

For each of the areas below, think about how your product could contribute to an ethical risk or concern. Check “☐ High,” “☐ Medium,” or “☐ Low” for each risk. If the risk is not applicable, check “N/A.” Most products will have many risks rated Low or N/A.

Access & Inclusion			
Are there particularly vulnerable stakeholders who could be affected by the technology, e.g. children or those living with disabilities?			
☐ High	☐ Medium	☐ Low	☐ N/A
Could the technology fail to respect different cultural norms and values?			
☐ High	☐ Medium	☐ Low	☐ N/A
Are users able to submit feedback? Do they need to be able to?			
☐ High	☐ Medium	☐ Low	☐ N/A
Could the technology increase the digital divide by being accessible only to certain socioeconomic groups?			
☐ High	☐ Medium	☐ Low	☐ N/A

Data Ethics			
Do users understand what data is collected, its use, storage duration, and ownership? Is this clearly communicated to users?			
☐ High	☐ Medium	☐ Low	☐ N/A
Could certain entities (e.g. law enforcement, governments, hackers, etc.) misuse your data on individuals? Are there protections against this?			
☐ High	☐ Medium	☐ Low	☐ N/A

Economic & Business Impacts			
Could your technology significantly disrupt existing markets and lead to seriously negative economic consequences?			
☐ High	☐ Medium	☐ Low	☐ N/A
Is your pricing transparent and fair?			
☐ High	☐ Medium	☐ Low	☐ N/A

User Autonomy & Control			
Does the technology have hidden functions or potential surprises for users that could impact their autonomy?			
☐ High	☐ Medium	☐ Low	☐ N/A
Does your business model prioritize maximizing user attention, and could that harm users?			
☐ High	☐ Medium	☐ Low	☐ N/A
Could this technology accelerate the spread of toxic or harmful content?			
☐ High	☐ Medium	☐ Low	☐ N/A

Ethics Injection Part 1: Risk Scoring *continued*

Algorithm & Design Ethics			
If the product makes significant decisions about people's lives, how easily understandable are those decisions? Are they explained clearly to users?			
☐ High	☐ Medium	☐ Low	☐ N/A
Can users understand how they're affected by the application's verdicts or recommendations?			
☐ High	☐ Medium	☐ Low	☐ N/A
Are there long-term implications for users' reputation or public image, given the way data is collected, stored, transferred, and used?			
☐ High	☐ Medium	☐ Low	☐ N/A
Does the product sort people in any potentially discriminatory ways?			
☐ High	☐ Medium	☐ Low	☐ N/A
Is there a potential for automation to overshadow human judgment?			
☐ High	☐ Medium	☐ Low	☐ N/A
Is it especially necessary to include diverse voices and perspectives in the design process?			
☐ High	☐ Medium	☐ Low	☐ N/A

Long-term & Indirect Impacts & Abuse			
Are there potential health or safety risks from the normal, intended use of the technology?			
☐ High	☐ Medium	☐ Low	☐ N/A
How might the tech be misused for harassment or abuse? Does the technology facilitate (i.e. make easier) abuse or bad behavior?			
☐ High	☐ Medium	☐ Low	☐ N/A

Accountability & Oversight			
Is there a redress system for unfair or incorrect algorithmic assessments?			
☐ High	☐ Medium	☐ Low	☐ N/A
Is there a need for ongoing ethical oversight?			
☐ High	☐ Medium	☐ Low	☐ N/A

Ethics Injection Part 2: Managing and Mitigating Risk

Below, select the top five (5) risks and elaborate on them. For each one, explain how the risk can emerge and explain one or two ideas for mitigating the risk, for example, in the design of the product, its marketing, user instructions, and so on.

Risk 1

What is the risk?

How might the risk manifest?

How might the risk be managed or mitigated?

Risk 2

What is the risk?

How might the risk manifest?

How might the risk be managed or mitigated?

Risk 3

What is the risk?

How might the risk manifest?

How might the risk be managed or mitigated?

Risk 4

What is the risk?

How might the risk manifest?

How might the risk be managed or mitigated?

Risk 5

What is the risk?

How might the risk manifest?

How might the risk be managed or mitigated?